THE ELON GAZETTE

Weekday briefing on what Elon Musk is saying and doing

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 13, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

$276 million for the midterms, a new name for FSD in Europe, and one subscription for Grok, Cursor and X

Elon Musk has given more than $276 million to Republican groups since July, making him the biggest known donor of the 2026 midterm elections, according to figures his representatives gave The New York Times and America PAC confirmed on Monday. That brings his known federal giving this cycle to about $366 million, more than the roughly $290 million he spent in 2024, after he said in May 2025 he would spend "a lot less."

At Tesla, Full Self-Driving (Supervised) is now "Tesla Assisted Driving" in Europe, a name change Germany's transport minister had demanded, and federal regulators opened a file on claims that robotaxis sped through school zones. SpaceX's AI arm folded Grok, Cursor and X Premium into one plan, The X Subscription, and Musk spent much of Monday night reposting praise for Grok Bot. SpaceX launched twice in ten hours, sending Starlink satellites up from California and a cargo Dragon toward the space station from Florida.

I · POLITICS

The biggest known donor of the midterms

Newly disclosed donations show Musk funding the Republican effort to hold Congress on a scale beyond his 2024 spending.

$276M	$158M	$366M
Given to Republican groups since July	To the Senate Leadership Fund super PAC	Known federal giving in the 2025–26 cycle

Where the money went

The largest share, $158 million, went to the Senate Leadership Fund, the main super PAC backing Republican Senate candidates, and more than $76 million to America PAC, the group Musk founded in 2024, CNBC reported; America PAC spokesperson Lindsey Curnutte confirmed the figures. Smaller sums went to the Congressional Leadership Fund ($20 million), the Lone Star Liberty PAC backing Ken Paxton's Senate bid in Texas ($10 million), the Republican Governors Association ($10 million) and the Republican Attorneys General Association ($2 million), The Verge reported.

America PAC runs a canvassing operation in seven Senate battlegrounds and nearly three dozen House races, and says it intends to stay active through the 2028 presidential election, The New York Times reported. Musk has also made seven-figure donations through groups that do not disclose donors, according to a person with knowledge of the matter, the Times added. The Associated Press called him "the world's only trillionaire." The election is November 3.

> *"In terms of political spending, I'm going to do a lot less in the future."*
>
> ELON MUSK · MAY 2025, VIA CNBC

On X

Musk weighed in on the Texas Senate race on Monday at 12:59 p.m. EDT, quoting a post that criticized Democratic candidate James Talarico with one word: "Troubling."

II · TESLA

"Assisted Driving" in Europe, school zones in Texas

Tesla gave Germany the rename it asked for. A federal petition asks whether robotaxis are speeding past schools.

A name change for EU approval

German Transport Minister Steffen Bilger had called the FSD name "misleading." Tesla agreed to rename the system "Tesla Assisted Driving" and has already done so on its websites in Germany and many other European countries, though not worldwide, electrive reported. Bilger now says he will "advocate for the system to be approved across Europe as soon as possible"; the EU vote is expected in December. In the US the product is still sold as FSD (Supervised).



A Tesla Cybercab on Harrison Street in San Francisco on June 12, 2026. A Cybercab from the Austin fleet went on display at the Paris Motor Show on Monday.

PHOTO: 9YZ, "TESLA CYBERCAB - SAN FRANCISCO - JUNE 2026," WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0 · CROPPED

Robotaxis

The National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) opened defect petition DP26010 on October 9 over claims that Tesla robotaxis sped through active school zones, citing three videos and four incidents and estimating the fleet at about 1,000 Model Y and Cybercab vehicles, Electrek reported. The agency has 120 days to decide whether to open an investigation. Hours earlier, Tesla's Robotaxi account listed longer hours (6 a.m. to 11 p.m.), shorter waits and Grok Bot in the Cybercab; Musk quoted it as "Robotaxi improvements."

> QUICK HIT
> **"Of course."** Florida Governor Ron DeSantis thanked Tesla for free Supercharging in areas hit by Hurricane Isaias. Musk replied at 12:41 a.m. EDT Tuesday: "Of course."

Replying to a post about a family who survived a crash in a Tesla, Musk wrote on Monday: "Your safety has always been priority 1 at Tesla and SpaceX."

III · SPACEX, GROK & X

The X Subscription, and a night of Grok Bot reposts

SpaceX Super Intelligence merged three product lines into one plan. Musk spent the evening amplifying users' praise for its agent.

One plan, five tiers

"We've unified plans across Grok, Cursor, and X Premium," SpaceX Super Intelligence posted at 7:08 p.m. EDT Monday. The X Subscription runs "from Free to Ultra," with paid tiers at $8, $30, $100 and $200 a month (pricing documentation); existing subscribers can keep their plans or switch.

"Like hiring a super smart employee"

Between Monday evening and Tuesday morning, Musk reposted or quoted about 20 users' posts about Grok Bot, the agent that runs tasks on a user's behalf. "It's awesome," he wrote on one; "Grok @Bot is like hiring a super smart employee," on another, at 6:31 a.m. EDT Tuesday. He also promoted a Grok Bot "memory transfer" that imports what other AI assistants have learned about a user (post).



A faint string of Starlink satellites crosses the night sky above the town hall in Tübingen, Germany, on April 24, 2020.

PHOTO: DKTUE · WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC0

Launches and a sabotage case

Falcon 9 launched 27 Starlink satellites from California at 8:28 p.m. EDT Monday, Spaceflight Now reported, and NASA's CRS-35 cargo Dragon lifted off from Florida at 6:33 a.m. EDT Tuesday, bound for docking on Thursday. In Poland, officials said two Turkish citizens were arrested in Germany over a September fire at a Starlink station that Warsaw blames on Russian intelligence, Al Jazeera reported.

On the record

No new interviews since Monday morning; a documentary about Musk drew reviews and a reaction from him.

"Musk," directed by Alex Gibney reviewed October 9–12, 2026

A nearly four-hour documentary on Musk's career. Ars Technica found it "feels like two different films"; the Los Angeles Times called it "exhausting, though not exhaustive."

Musk answered a post about one review with a laughing emoji on Monday.

Donations coverage October 12, 2026

The New York Times (via The Philadelphia Inquirer) · AP · CNBC · The Verge · Al Jazeera

Takeaways

1. **Musk has given $276 million to Republican groups since July, about $366 million this cycle, more than in 2024.**
2. **FSD is "Tesla Assisted Driving" in Europe, and Germany's minister now backs EU-wide approval.**
3. **NHTSA is weighing a robotaxi school-zone speeding petition covering about 1,000 vehicles.**
4. **The X Subscription merges Grok, Cursor and X Premium; Musk is promoting Grok Bot heavily.**
5. **Next: the Roadster demonstration near Waco on Thursday, October 15.**

Sources

Posts by @elonmusk, @SpaceXSI, @robotaxi, @SpaceX and @RonDeSantis.

CNBC · AP · The Philadelphia Inquirer / The New York Times · The Verge · electrive · Electrek · SpaceXSI docs · Spaceflight Now · Al Jazeera · Ars Technica · Los Angeles Times · Photos: Wikimedia Commons (9yz, CC BY 4.0; Dktue, CC0)

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